

Google tightens policy to tackle malicious Android apps

There are reports that almost every Android device is infected with malicious applications, as warned by British Telecom, which has come up with some eyebrow-raising statements about the Android operating system. It seems Google has taken a note of this, and has changed the rules for applications on its Android mobile operating system in a bid to cut down on malicious apps.

The new policy changes for apps submitted to the Google Play application store include new rules on app naming, a ban on apps that disclose personal information without permission and more details on the payment policy.

It seems that Google is in no mood to destroy Android's popularity and has sent strict instructions to app developers. Stricter controls on app names and icons have been introduced to eliminate copycat apps that attempt to trick users. According to a Tech Radar report, Google's new terms tell developers: "Don't pretend to be someone else, and don't represent that your application is authorised by or produced by another company or organisation, if that is not the case." Also, developers are warned that apps that introduce security vulnerabilities or 'harm user devices' will not be permitted.

Google is also getting strict about spamming. It has set down new rules against apps that 'spam' users by delivering repetitive content or the ones that try to achieve better positions in the Google Play store by artificially boosting ratings. In a letter to app developers, the Android team wrote: "We are constantly striving to make Google Play a great community for developers and consumers. This requires us to update our policies when we launch new features, like subscription billing, and also when we see unhealthy behaviour, like deceptive app names and spammy notifications."

Introducing Honeywell's Android enterprise digital assistant

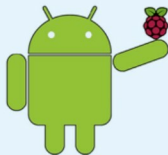
Now, Honeywell has added Android to the enterprise digital assistant. The first to do so, it has introduced the Dolphin 7800 Android handheld computer for sales representatives whose work involves multiple customer stops.

Honeywell Scanning & Mobility and Microsoft Corp also signed a patent agreement that provides broad coverage under Microsoft's patent portfolio for Honeywell's products running on the Android or Chrome OS platforms. The Dolphin 7800 Android offers better features to businesses that issue the device to their employees—it even has the ability to remotely secure a lost device. With Honeywell's Remote MasterMind 3.0 device management



Android ICS in Raspberry Pi

The Raspberry Pi website has revealed an exciting update – the arrival of Android 4.0. This is great news for Linux fans with a sweet tooth! According to the website, hardware-accelerated graphics and videos have been up and running smoothly for some time; AudioFlinger support is the only major missing piece at the moment.



Ice Cream Sandwich is definitely the flavour of this summer. The website further reads, "This implementation uses a different kernel and VideoCore binary image from the one available on GitHub, which is why we've been keeping quiet about it so far. We're investigating the feasibility of converging the two code lines to produce a single common platform as soon as we can, at which point we hope to release the sources for you to play with."

The Raspberry Pi is an ARM GNU Linux box or a mini computer built on a single board. Powered by an ARM processor on a Broadcom BCM2835 SoC, it has a 700 MHz processor, 256 MB of RAM and Video 4 GPU that allows the device to handle full HD video playback and even 40 MBps Blu-ray streams with ease. One of the two models has an Ethernet port and two USB ports, which allows users to connect external drives.

The Raspberry Pi is the most pocket friendly power packed device. About 4,000 Raspberry Pis are being made every day, and one can buy it from RS Components, element14 or Premier Farnell.